

White bean and roasted fennel salad with honey-miso dressing

This salad speaks for itself, both visually and with its flavor. When roasted and browned, fresh fennel takes on a lovely **nutty** quality. Serve with a simple grain dish and a green salad.

½ pound dried white beans (1 cup) [250g]

2 tablespoons olive oil

1 large fennel bulb, trimmed and coarsely chopped, leaves reserved

1 teaspoon salt

½ red onion, thinly sliced

½ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

1 head of garlic, cloves separated and sliced into thick slivers

Honey-Miso Dressing (recipe follows)

8 large cherry tomatoes, quartered

1. **Place** the beans in a large pot with enough cold water to cover by about 2 inches [5cm]. Soak for 6 to 8 hours or overnight.
2. Drain the beans and cover again with fresh water. Bring to a **boil**; reduce the heat to a simmer and cook until the beans are tender but not falling apart, 45 to 60 minutes. Drain and rinse under cold running water until cool. Drain well.
3. While the beans are cooking, preheat the oven to 375°F [190°C]. In a medium bowl, **toss** the fennel, red onion, and garlic with the olive oil to coat. Season with ½ teaspoon of the salt and ¼ teaspoon of the pepper. Spread out in a baking dish or on a baking sheet and roast, stirring every 20 minutes, for 1 hour, or until the vegetables are lightly browned.
4. In a large bowl, **combine** the beans, roasted vegetables, and half the dressing. Toss to mix well. Add the cherry tomatoes and toss gently with the remaining dressing. Season with the remaining salt and pepper. Garnish with the reserved fennel leaves. If you have time, let the salad stand at room temperature for an hour before serving, tossing occasionally, to allow the flavors to develop.

SERVES 4 TO 6

Honey-miso dressing

¼ cup extra virgin olive oil [60ml]

2 teaspoons honey

2 tablespoons white wine vinegar

2 teaspoons chickpea miso or white miso

In a small bowl, **whisk** together all of the ingredients until well blended.

MAKES ABOUT ½ CUP [125ML]

